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Rules Contributing to Suspicious Access Attempt to Windows Object Alerts

The following rules are used to identify suspicious activity with access attempt to Windows objects. Any one or more of these will trigger Suspicious Access Attempt to Windows Object Alert. Details for each rule can be viewed by clicking the **More Details** link in the description.

Windows Events Required: 4657, 4663

The Windows Detect Profile (Low Volume) covers these required Windows events.

Title	Description

SysKey Registry Keys Access	Detects handle requests and access operations to specific registry keys to calculate the SysKey
	
	More details
	
	Rule ID
	
	`windows_security_2`
	
	Query
	
	`{'selection': {'EventID': [4656, 4663], 'ObjectType': 'Key', 'ObjectName|endswith': ['\\Lsa\\JD', '\\Lsa\\GBG', '\\Lsa\\Skew1', '\\Lsa\\Data']}, 'condition': 'selection'}`
	
	Log Source
	
	Stellar Cyber Windows Server Sensor configured for:
	
	• Collecting Windows security events
	
	Rule Source
	
	SigmaHQ,9a4ff3b8-6187-4fd2-8e8b-e0eae1129495
	
	Author: Roberto Rodriguez @Cyb3rWard0g
	
	Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures
	
	TA0007, T1012
	
	References
	
	• https://threathunterplaybook.com/hunts/windows/190625-RegKeyAccessSyskey/notebook.html

Title	Description
	Severity 75 **Suppression Logic Based On** • computer_name • event_data.ObjectName • stellar.rule_id **Additional Information** **Maturity**: test **Creation Date**: 2019/08/12 **Risk Level**: high **False Positives** • Unknown

Sysmon Channel Reference Deletion	Potential threat actor tampering with Sysmon manifest and eventually disabling it
	More details
	Rule ID
	`windows_security_19`
	Query
	`{'selection1': {'EventID': 4657, 'ObjectName|contains': ['WINEVT\\Publishers\\{5770385f-c22a-43e0-bf4c-06f5698ffbd9}', 'WINEVT\\Channels\\Microsoft-Windows-Sysmon/Operational'], 'ObjectValueName': 'Enabled', 'NewValue': '0'}, 'selection2': {'EventID': 4663, 'ObjectName|contains': ['WINEVT\\Publishers\\{5770385f-c22a-43e0-bf4c-06f5698ffbd9}', 'WINEVT\\Channels\\Microsoft-Windows-Sysmon/Operational'], 'AccessMask': '0x10000'}, 'condition': '1 of selection*'}`
	Log Source
	Stellar Cyber Windows Server Sensor configured for:
	• Collecting Windows security events
	Rule Source
	SigmaHQ,18beca67-ab3e-4ee3-ba7a-a46ca8d7d0cc
	Author: Roberto Rodriguez (Cyb3rWard0g), OTR (Open Threat Research)
	Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures
	TA0005, T1112
	References
	• https://twitter.com/Flangvik/status/1283054508084473861
	• https://twitter.com/SecurityJosh/status/1283027365770276866
	• https://securityjosh.github.io/2020/04/23/Mute-Sysmon.html
	• https://gist.github.com/Cyb3rWard0g/cf08c38c61f7e46e8404b38201ca01c8
	Severity
	75
	Suppression Logic Based On
	• computer_name
	• event_data.ObjectName
	• stellar.rule_id
	Additional Information
	Maturity: test
	Creation Date: 2020/07/14
	Risk Level: high
	False Positives
	• Unknown

Title	Description

Suspicious Teams Application Related ObjectAcess Event	Detects an access to authentication tokens and accounts of Microsoft Teams desktop application.
	
	More details
	
	Rule ID
	
	`windows_security_24`
	
	Query
	
	`{'selection': {'EventID': 4663, 'ObjectName|contains': ['\\Microsoft\\Teams\\Cookies', '\\Microsoft\\Teams\\Local Storage\\leveldb']}, 'filter': {'ProcessName|contains': '\\Microsoft\\Teams\\current\\Teams.exe'}, 'condition': 'selection and not filter'}`
	
	Log Source
	
	Stellar Cyber Windows Server Sensor configured for:
	
	• Collecting Windows security events
	
	Rule Source
	
	SigmaHQ,25cde13e-8e20-4c29-b949-4e795b76f16f
	
	Author: @SerkinValery
	
	Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures
	
	TA0006, T1528
	
	References
	
	• https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/microsoft-teams-stores-auth-tokens-as-cleartext-in-windows-linux-macs/
	• https://www.vectra.ai/blogpost/undermining-microsoft-teams-security-by-mining-tokens
	
	Severity
	
	75
	
	Suppression Logic Based On
	
	• computer_name
	• event_data.ObjectName
	• stellar.rule_id
	
	Additional Information
	
	Maturity: experimental
	Creation Date: 2022/09/16
	Risk Level: high
	False Positives:
	• Unknown

Processes Accessing the Microphone and Webcam	Potential adversaries accessing the microphone and webcam in an endpoint.
	
	More details
	
	Rule ID
	
	`windows_security_48`
	
	Query
	
	`{'selection': {'EventID': [4657, 4656, 4663], 'ObjectName|contains': ['\\SOFTWARE\\Microsoft\\Windows\\CurrentVersion\\CapabilityAccessManager\\ConsentStore\\microphone\\NonPackaged', '\\SOFTWARE\\Microsoft\\Windows\\CurrentVersion\\CapabilityAccessManager\\ConsentStore\\webcam\\NonPackaged']}, 'condition': 'selection'}`

Title	Description
	Log Source Stellar Cyber Windows Server Sensor configured for: • Collecting Windows security events **Rule Source** SigmaHQ,8cd538a4-62d5-4e83-810b-12d41e428d6e Author: Roberto Rodriguez (Cyb3rWard0g), OTR (Open Threat Research) **Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures** TA0009, T1123 **References** • https://twitter.com/duzvik/status/1269671601852813320 • https://medium.com/@7a616368/can-you-track-processes-accessing-the-camera-and-microphone-7e6885b37072 **Severity** 50 **Suppression Logic Based On** • computer_name • event_data.ObjectName • stellar.rule_id **Additional Information** Maturity: test Creation Date: 2020/06/07 Risk Level: medium False Positives: • Unknown

Microsoft Entra Health Service Agents Registry Keys Access	This detection uses Windows security events to detect suspicious access attempts to the registry key values and sub-keys of Microsoft Entra Health service agents (e.g AD FS). Information from AD Health service agents can be used to potentially abuse some of the features provided by those services in the cloud (e.g. Federation). This detection requires an access control entry (ACE) on the system access control list (SACL) of the following securable object: HKLM:\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\ADHealthAgent. Make sure you set the SACL to propagate to its sub-keys.
	More details
	Rule ID
	`windows_security_54`
	Query
	`{'selection': {'EventID': [4656, 4663], 'ObjectType': 'Key', 'ObjectName': '\\REGISTRY\\MACHINE\\SOFTWARE\\Microsoft\\ADHealthAgent'}, 'filter': {'ProcessName|contains': ['Microsoft.Identity.Health.Adfs.DiagnosticsAgent.exe', 'Microsoft.Identity.Health.Adfs.InsightsService.exe', 'Microsoft.Identity.Health.Adfs.MonitoringAgent.Startup.exe', 'Microsoft.Identity.Health.Adfs.PshSurrogate.exe', 'Microsoft.Identity.Health.Common.Clients.ResourceMonitor.exe']}, 'condition': 'selection and not filter'}`
	Log Source
	Stellar Cyber Windows Server Sensor configured for:
	• Collecting Windows security events
	Rule Source
	SigmaHQ,1d2ab8ac-1a01-423b-9c39-001510eae8e8

Title	Description
	Au Roberto Rodriguez (Cyb3rWard0g), OTR (Open Threat Research), MSTIC **Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures** TA0007, T1012 **References** • https://o365blog.com/post/hybridhealthagent/ • https://github.com/OTRF/Set-AuditRule/blob/c3dec5443414231714d850565d364ca73475ade5/rules/registry/aad_connect_health_service_agent.yml **Severity** 50 **Suppression Logic Based On** • computer_name • event_data.ObjectName • stellar.rule_id **Additional Information** Maturity: test Creation Date: 2021/08/26 Risk Level: medium False Positives: • Unknown

Microsoft Entra Health Monitoring Agent Registry Keys Access	This detection uses Windows security events to detect suspicious access attempts to the registry key of Microsoft Entra Health monitoring agent. This detection requires an access control entry (ACE) on the system access control list (SACL) of the following securable object HKLM\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Microsoft Online\Reporting\MonitoringAgent.
	
	More details
	
	Rule ID
	
	`windows_security_70`
	
	Query
	
	`{'selection': {'EventID': [4656, 4663], 'ObjectType': 'Key', 'ObjectName': '\\REGISTRY\\MACHINE\\SOFTWARE\\Microsoft\\Microsoft Online\\Reporting\\MonitoringAgent'}, 'filter': {'ProcessName|contains': ['Microsoft.Identity.Health.Adfs.DiagnosticsAgent.exe', 'Microsoft.Identity.Health.Adfs.InsightsService.exe', 'Microsoft.Identity.Health.Adfs.MonitoringAgent.Startup.exe', 'Microsoft.Identity.Health.Adfs.PshSurrogate.exe', 'Microsoft.Identity.Health.Common.Clients.ResourceMonitor.exe']}, 'condition': 'selection and not filter'}`
	
	Log Source
	
	Stellar Cyber Windows Server Sensor configured for:
	
	• Collecting Windows security events
	
	Rule Source
	
	SigmaHQ,ff151c33-45fa-475d-af4f-c2f93571f4fe
	
	Author: Roberto Rodriguez (Cyb3rWard0g), OTR (Open Threat Research), MSTIC
	
	Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures
	
	TA0007, T1012
	
	References
	
	• https://o365blog.com/post/hybridhealthagent/
	• https://github.com/OTRF/Set-AuditRule/blob/c3dec5443414231714d850565d364ca73475ade5/rules/registry/a

Title	Description
	ad_connect_health_monitoring_agent.yml **Severity** 50 **Suppression Logic Based On** • computer_name • event_data.ObjectName • stellar.rule_id **Additional Information** **Maturity**: test **Creation Date**: 2021/08/26 **Risk Level**: medium **False Positives** • Unknown

WCE wceaux.dll Access	Detects wceaux.dll access while WCE pass-the-hash remote command execution on source host
	More details
	Rule ID
	`windows_security_93`
	Query
	`{'selection': {'EventID': [4656, 4658, 4660, 4663], 'Object Name|endswith': '\\wceaux.dll'}, 'condition': 'selection'}`
	Log Source
	Stellar Cyber Windows Server Sensor configured for:
	• Collecting Windows security events
	Rule Source
	SigmaHQ,1de68c67-af5c-4097-9c85-fe5578e09e67
	Author: Thomas Patzke
	Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures
	TA0006, T1003
	References
	• https://www.jpcert.or.jp/english/pub/sr/ir_research.html
	• https://jpcertcc.github.io/ToolAnalysisResultSheet
	Severity
	90
	Suppression Logic Based On
	• computer_name
	• event_data.ObjectName
	• stellar.rule_id
	Additional Information
	Maturity: test
	Creation Date: 2017/06/14
	Risk Level: critical
	False Positives
	• Unknown

Secure Deletion with SDelete	Detects renaming of file while deletion with SDelete tool. More details **Rule ID** `windows_security_101`

Title	Description
	Q `{'selection': {'EventID': [4656, 4663, 4658], 'ObjectName|endswith': ['.AAA', '.ZZZ']}, 'condition': 'selection'}` **Log Source** Stellar Cyber Windows Server Sensor configured for: • Collecting Windows security events **Rule Source** SigmaHQ,39a80702-d7ca-4a83-b776-525b1f86a36d Author: Thomas Patzke **Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures** TA0005, T1070.004, T1027.005, T1553.002, TA0040, T1485 **References** • https://jpcertcc.github.io/ToolAnalysisResultSheet/details/sdelete.htm • https://www.jpcert.or.jp/english/pub/sr/ir_research.html • https://docs.microsoft.com/en-gb/sysinternals/downloads/sdelete **Severity** 50 **Suppression Logic Based On** • computer_name • event_data.ObjectName • stellar.rule_id **Additional Information** **Maturity**: test **Creation Date**: 2017/06/14 **Risk Level**: medium **False Positives** • Legitimate usage of SDelete

Windows Defender Exclusion Set	Detects scenarios where an windows defender exclusion was added in registry where an entity would want to bypass antivirus scanning from windows defender
	More details
	Rule ID
	`windows_security_111`
	Query
	`{'selection': {'EventID': [4657, 4656, 4660, 4663], 'ObjectName|contains': '\\Microsoft\\Windows Defender\\Exclusions\\'}, 'condition': 'selection'}`
	Log Source
	Stellar Cyber Windows Server Sensor configured for:
	• Collecting Windows security events
	• Requirements: Audit Policy : Security Settings/Local Policies/Audit Policy, Registry System Access Control (SACL): Auditing/User
	Rule Source
	SigmaHQ,e9c8808f-4cfb-4ba9-97d4-e5f3beaa244d
	Author: @BarryShooshooga, Nasreddine Bencherchali (Nextron Systems)
	Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures

Title	Description
	TA[illegible]2, T1562.001

References

- https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/gootkit-malware-bypasses-windows-defender-by-setting-path-exclusions/

Severity

75

Suppression Logic Based On

- computer_name
- event_data.ObjectName
- stellar.rule_id

Additional Information

Maturity	Creation Date	Risk Level	False Positives
test	2019/10/26	high	• Intended inclusions by administrator

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